Cyclistic: Converting Casual Riders into Annual Members

Executive summary for Lily Moreno, Director of Marketing | Marketing Analytics | Divvy 2019 trip data, 3.8 million rides

Bottom line

Casual riders use the bikes for **leisure**; members use them for **commuting**. Casual riders ride in summer, on weekends, on longer trips, and from a small set of lakefront and downtown stations. That points to three levers for conversion: **timing, place and message**.

What the data shows

Measure	Casual	Member
Share of all rides	**23.0%**	**77.0%**
Rides in June to September	**70.6%**	**50.9%**
Rides on weekends	**43.0%**	**18.5%**
Rides in weekday commute hours*	**21.3%**	**47.6%**
Median ride length	**25.8 min**	**9.8 min**
Rides starting at the top 10 stations	**25.8%**	**11.6%**

*Weekday rides starting between 07:00-09:59 and 16:00-18:59.

Recommendations (each tested as a small pilot with a control group)

1. **Time it.** Launch an upgrade offer in April and May, before casual riding peaks. *Metric: casual-to-member conversion within 60 days.*
2. **Place it.** Add sign-up QR codes and geo-targeted ads at the top stations, starting with Streeter Dr & Grand Ave and Lake Shore Dr & Monroe St. *Metric: sign-ups per 1,000 casual rides.*
3. **Pitch it.** Sell year-round commuting value to repeat weekday casual riders; 118,580 casual rides (13.5%) already look like member trips. *Metric: conversion rate and winter retention.*

Data confidence (ROCCC)

Reliable (pass): no duplicate IDs or missing core fields; 99.95% of rides kept after a logged cleaning pass.
Original (pass): first-party operator trip logs; Divvy stands in for Cyclistic.
Comprehensive (partial): no pricing, rider IDs, bike type or coordinates.
Current (partial): 2019 data; validate on recent data before launch.
Cited (pass): Divvy data, provided by Motivate International Inc. under its license agreement.

Limitations

Rides, not riders: we cannot see how often one person rides.
Visitors and locals look alike, and visitors rarely convert, so the convertible audience is smaller than casual volume suggests.
Descriptive only: there is no conversion data, so every recommendation is a hypothesis to test.
Recommendation 3 rests on a heuristic segment, not a confirmed customer group.

Decisions requested

Approve the three pilots; have Finance review offer economics; request pass-type, repeat-purchase and home-ZIP data from Cyclistic's customer systems.

Source: Divvy trip data, Motivate International Inc., under the Divvy Data License Agreement. Cyclistic is a fictional company created for the Google Data Analytics case study. Prepared by Hazaimi Hamdani.